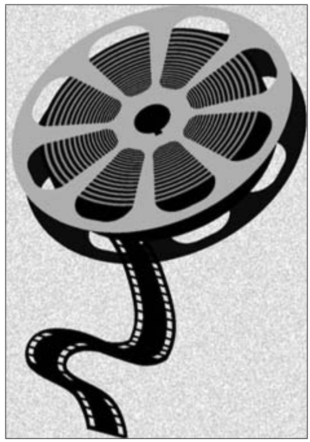
At 25 fps or faster, however, video always looks realistic and smooth. The standard frame rate for analogue video is 25 fps for PAL (Phase Alternation Line) video, and 30 fps for NTSC (National Television Systems Committee) video. PAL and NTSC are the different kinds of video formats we receive TV signals in. Most countries use the standard PAL video format. NTSC is more prevalent in the US.

What Is Analogue Video?



Analogue video transmits or stores video data in a continuous wave of red green and blue (RGB). The signal is varied using different frequencies of each colour's wave to display changing images at the receiver's end. Since this format involves an unbroken transmission of wave data, it is prone to noise (distortion). However, since this continuous stream of data is very similar to the way we humans perceive the world-our eyes receive a continuous stream of light waves, which our brain perceives as moving images (video)-analogue video data represents reality better.

What Is Digital Video?

Digital video is nothing more than a series of images, all stored in digital format (ones and zeroes) that is displayed in quick succession on a screen (such as a computer monitor).

A digital video recorder, for example, takes analogue signals (light waves) and records them into a digital representation of the analogue data. So almost all digital video is nothing but a computer's understanding of analogue video. There are exceptions, such as in the case of, say, games, where there is no analogue data to begin with, and all the data is created and displayed digitally.